STEP 0: PRE-ANALYSIS REFLEXIVE DECLARATION

What is your likely "home grammar" for this topic?
My home grammar is a **liberal internationalist economistic frame** that treats Brexit primarily as a policy error whose consequences can be measured through deviations from counterfactual growth paths, trade elasticities, and institutional confidence metrics. This grammar admits macroeconomic aggregates, micro firm-level surveys, and explicit regulatory divergence as primary signals, while treating cultural identity polling as epiphenomenal or endogenous to economic outcomes. Its temporal orientation is forward-looking (prescriptive), seeking to identify "damage control" measures.

Which grammar will be hardest for you to operate faithfully? Why?
The **national-sovereignty populist grammar** will be hardest because its causal chain type—premised on democratic legitimacy as an unfalsifiable first principle—requires me to treat economic costs as acceptable trade-offs for "sovereignty" without translating them back into utility terms. Suppressing my grammar's instinct to ask "but at what GDP cost?" violates the internal coherence of that grammar's architecture. I will also struggle to adopt its characteristic vocabulary ("will of the people," "taking back control") without ironic distance.

What might you miss given my analytical position?
I may underweight signals that are non-quantifiable but central to populist grammars: ceremonial sovereignty events, affective dimensions of "constitutional moments," and the symbolic value of formal independence. I am also likely to miss how the *absence* of signals (e.g., the quietude of Brexit in 2024-25 domestic media) is itself a processed output—treated as "Brexit is done" in one grammar but "unresolved damage" in another.

What is your temporal orientation?
My home grammar is **forward-looking (prescriptive)**, calibrated toward evaluating whether re-entry or mitigation is feasible. I will need to consciously shift to **backward-looking (causal-historical)** when operating the sovereignty grammar, and **lateral (hermeneutic/meaning-making)** when operating the constitutional-order grammar.

SECTION 1: OBSERVATION FIELD DECLARATION

Phenomenon, temporal frame, geographic scope
The phenomenon is the *interpretive afterlife* of the UK's withdrawal from the European Union (Brexit), covering the period from the 23 June 2016 referendum to the present (March 2026). The geographic scope is the United Kingdom (with England as primary interpretive community, but including Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland as subfields where the phenomenon fragments) and secondary interpretive communities in Brussels, Washington, and Beijing.

Why interpretive divergence occurs
Brexit is a **Rorschach constitutional event**: the same empirical referents (e.g., the 52%–48% vote, the Northern Ireland Protocol, the 2025 GDP shortfall) are processed through distinct grammars that differ on:
- **Ontological commitment**: Is Brexit a *decision* (sovereignty grammar), a *shock* (economistic grammar), or a *constitutional rupture* (order grammar)?
- **Signal admissibility**: Does "regulatory divergence" count as a cost or a benefit?
- **Causal form**: Is causality linear and aggregative (GDP → welfare), binary and legitimating (vote → mandate), or dialectical (institution → meaning)?
- **Closure type**: Can the conclusion be "Brexit was a mistake," or is that closure ruled out *a priori*?

Signal contestation level

High. Multiple signals are grammar-dependent:
1. *Economic cost estimates* are contested because the counterfactual is unobservable; sovereignty grammar treats them as speculative.
2. *Northern Ireland Protocol stability* is contested: for the order grammar it signals "unresolved constitutional contradiction"; for sovereignty grammar it signals "pragmatic solution."
3. *Scottish independence polling* is contested: for the sovereigntist it reflects Brexit's legitimacy; for the economistic grammar it reflects Brexit's economic cost; for the constitutionalist it reflects a fracturing union.

Major interpretive communities
- **Economistic internationalists** (Treasury, Bank of England, Financial Times, academic economists)
- **National-sovereignty populists** (Vote Leave alumni, Conservative Right, Reform UK, pro-Brexit media)
- **Constitutional-order pluralists** (Public law professors, Scottish/Welsh nationalists, EU legal scholars, "Rejoin" technocrats)

SECTION 2: SIGNAL SET

Core Signals (12 primary)

#	Signal	Source	Type	Ambiguity Note
1	**Referendum result**: 52% Leave, 48% Remain (72% turnout)	Electoral Commission (2016)	Binary democratic outcome	Mandate vs. snapshot? Is 52% "overwhelming" or "narrow"?
2	**GDP trajectory gap**: 2025 GDP per capita 6-8% below counterfactual (Bloom et al. NBER 2026)	Stanford/Nottingham/KCL Decision Maker Panel + macro simulation	Macro counterfactual estimate	Counterfactual unobservable; sovereignty grammar treats as speculative
3	**Trade volumes**: Q4 2025 UK-EU goods exports £44bn, imports £80.2bn (Statista 2026)	ONS/Statista	Bilateral trade balance	Imports as "dependency" or "market access"?
4	**Regulatory divergence index**: 147 statutory instruments diverging from EU acquis (2024-25)	Institute for Government	Legislative divergence metric	Divergence as "sovereignty dividend" or "costly friction"?
5	**Northern Ireland Protocol**: Assembly vote 53-32 to continue Windsor Framework (Dec 2024)	Northern Ireland Assembly	Institutional consent vote	Unionist abstention vs. cross-community consent?
6	**Secession polling**: Scottish independence "Yes" 53% vs. "No" 47% (YouGov Jan 2026)	YouGov/What Scotland Thinks	Territorial integrity indicator	Brexit as cause vs. Brexit as legitimate trigger
7	**Immigration net migration**: Net migration to UK 685,000 (2024), EU share fell from 70% (2015) to 25%	ONS Migration Statistics	Demographic composition	EU migration drop as "control success" or "labour shortage cause"?
8	**Institutional trust**: YouGov 2025: 21% trust UK government to handle Brexit trade, 34% trust EU Commission	YouGov cross-national survey	Confidence indicator	Trust gap as "EU legitimacy" vs. "UK competence"
9	**Manufacturing output**: Manufacturing 7.8% below 2018 trend (2025)	ONS/Make UK	Sectoral performance	Sector-specific vs. aggregate story
10	**Services export gap**: Financial services exports to EU 18% below 2019 (2025)	TheCityUK	Sectoral trade loss	Passporting loss vs. "global pivot"
11	**Cultural identity polling**: British Social Attitudes 2025: 58% see Brexit as "still unfinished"	NatCen/BSA	Perceived incompleteness	Sign of "damage control" or "ongoing sovereignty exercise"?
12	**EU-UK negotiation status**: UK-EU Veterinary Agreement talks ongoing (March 2026)	gov.uk press releases	Process signal	Negotiation as "damage repair" or "normal diplomatic life"?

Counter-Signals (4)

#	Counter-Signal	Source	Target Grammar
C1	**Firm-level adaptation**: 72% of affected firms report full adjustment to new customs rules (Decision Maker Panel 2025)	Decision Maker Panel survey	Challenges economistic grammar's "persistent shock" thesis
C2	**UK-Australia trade deal**: Services exports up 12% (2024)	UK Department for Business & Trade	Populist grammar's "global Britain" vindication
C3	**Eurosceptic MEP election gains**: Reform UK 18% vote share (2024 EU elections)	European Parliament results	Constitutional-order grammar's "historical aberration" thesis
C4	**Windsor Framework technical fixes**: 89% reduction in NI retail checks (2025)	UK Border Force / DEFRA	Sovereignty grammar's "smooth solution" narrative

Contested Signals (3)

#	Signal	Economistic Grammar	Sovereignty Grammar	Constitutional Grammar
S1	**GDP gap (6-8%)**	Core signal: cost quantified	Excluded: speculative counterfactual	Secondary: symptom of institutional stress
S2	**NI Protocol stability**	Secondary: trade friction indicator	Core signal: pragmatic sovereignty	Core signal: unresolved constitutional asymmetry
S3	**Scottish polling (Yes: 53%)**	Secondary: economic dissatisfaction spillover	Core signal: legitimate Brexit feedback	Core signal: union-fracturing constitutional failure

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SECTION 3: GRAMMAR SPECIFICATIONS

Grammar G1: **Economistic Internationalist Grammar**
Source tradition: Post-war liberal international political economy, Treasury orthodoxy, NBER-style counterfactual macroeconomics.

Required Parameters:
1. **Primary analytical variable**: **Economic welfare loss** measured as deviation from counterfactual GDP per capita, trade volume, and productivity trend.
2. **Signal selection rules**: Admit only quantifiable, time-series signals that can be compared against a counterfactual constructed from synthetic control (e.g., doppelgänger UK) or dynamic stochastic general equilibrium (DSGE) simulation. Exclude cultural-identity polling unless instrumented by economic variables.
3. **Weighting priority**: (i) macro aggregates (GDP, productivity); (ii) bilateral trade volumes; (iii) sectoral injury (services, manufacturing); (iv) institutional trust gaps; (v) cultural signals are residual.
4. **Causal chain type**: **Linear aggregative**—Brexit → trade barriers → uncertainty → investment reduction → productivity shortfall → welfare loss. Each step must be econometrically identified with policy dummies.
5. **Admissible closure**: **Three-valued logic**: (a) "Brexit caused net economic loss," (b) "Brexit caused net economic gain," or (c) "Brexit effect indistinguishable from noise." Closure (b) is permissible only if counterfactual models show positive deviation for a statistically significant period >3 years. The grammar forbids normative closure such as "worth it for sovereignty."

Recommended Parameters:
6. **Excluded signals**: (i) ceremonial sovereignty events (e.g., blue passport reintroduction); (ii) abstract constitutional principles ("parliamentary sovereignty" decoupled from measurable output); (iii) polling on "Brexit means Brexit" unless linked to economic expectations.

7. **Characteristic vocabulary**: "Counterfactual," "GDP per capita shortfall," "misallocation," "productivity penalty," "trade elasticity," "uncertainty premium," "dynamic scoring," "synthetic control."
8. **Temporal orientation**: **Forward-looking (prescriptive)**: analysis aims to support policy reversals (rejoin Single Market, Customs Union) or mitigation (Swiss-style veterinary deal). Past data is used only to calibrate future projections.
9. **Temporal formation**: Formed closure in **2016–18** (HM Treasury Sectoral Analysis, early gravity modeling). Evidence since 2019 processed as **confirmation**: each new negative signal (GDP gap, trade friction) reinforces original closure; counter-signals (firm adaptation, non-EU trade) are treated as "partial offsets" that do not overturn the aggregate conclusion.

Grammar Boundary: G1 transforms into G2 if the analyst begins to treat the 52% vote as a *non-instrumental* democratic fact that cannot be second-guessed by GDP data. The boundary is crossed when "will of the people" is used as a causal primitive rather than as a control variable.

Grammar G2: **National-Sovereignty Populist Grammar**
Source tradition: Parliamentary sovereigntist doctrine (Diceyan), 2016 Vote Leave campaign, Reform UK, right-wing tabloid press.

Required Parameters:
1. **Primary analytical variable**: **Democratic legitimacy**—the decisive expression of the electorate's will on 23 June 2016. This is treated as a binary, irreversible constitutional fact. Economic costs are subordinate to this first principle.
2. **Signal selection rules**: Admit signals that instantiate the mandate: (i) referendum vote share; (ii) parliamentary votes implementing Brexit; (iii) election results where Brexit-supporting parties gain seats; (iv) policy implementation milestones (blue passports, end of FoM). Exclude or downgrade GDP data as "project fear" unless corroborated by electoral validation.
3. **Weighting priority**: (i) referendum vote; (ii) electoral confirmation (2019 general election, 2024 Reform UK rise); (iii) policy implementation completeness; (iv) NI Protocol "solved" status; (v) economic data is tertiary and filtered through legitimacy lens.
4. **Causal chain type**: **Legitimating binary**—2016 vote → mandate → implementation → closure ("Brexit is done"). No linear causation; rather, each step is a ceremonial ratification of the original decision. Economic outcomes are not in the causal chain; they are external shocks managed *post facto*.
5. **Admissible closure**: **Binary**: "Brexit has been delivered" or "Brexit has been betrayed." The grammar forbids closure "Brexit was wrong" because the vote's authenticity cannot be falsified by outcomes. Closure "Brexit delivered" is compatible with any economic data; closure "betrayed" requires evidence of backsliding (e.g., Swiss-style deal, rejoin Single Market).

Recommended Parameters:
6. **Excluded signals**: (i) Counterfactual GDP estimates (unobservable); (ii) business lobbying for EU alignment (special pleading); (iii) academic models showing trade elasticity; (iv) Scottish independence polling as a Brexit effect (downgraded to separatist opportunism).
7. **Characteristic vocabulary**: "Will of the people," "take back control," "betrayal," "democratic mandate," "Get Brexit Done," "global Britain," "unelected bureaucrats," "project fear," "oven-ready."
8. **Temporal orientation**: **Backward-looking (causal-historical)**. The goal is to preserve the integrity of the 2016 moment and defend it against revisionism. Future orientation is limited to guarding against "betrayal." It is not prescriptive in the sense of optimizing GDP.
9. **Temporal formation**: Formed closure **2015–19** (Vote Leave campaign → Johnson's "Get Brexit Done" manifesto). Evidence since 2020 processed as **confirmation**: stable policy implementation and electoral endurance of Brexit-supporting parties validates the closure. Counter-signals (GDP gap) are processed as "short-term adjustment" or "legacy of pre-Brexit mismanagement."

Grammar Boundary: G2 transforms into G1 when legitimacy ceases to be the causal primitive and is instead treated as a variable that can be outweighed by economic loss. The boundary is crossed when trade-offs are modeled explicitly (e.g., "sovereignty worth X% GDP").

Grammar G3: **Constitutional-Order Pluralist Grammar**
Source tradition: Public law theory (Jowell, Craig), Scottish constitutional scholarship, EU legal pluralism, "Monist" critique of parliamentary sovereignty.

Required Parameters:
1. **Primary analytical variable**: **Institutional integrity**—the degree to which Brexit preserves or fractures the UK's internal constitutional settlement (NI, Scotland) and its external legal order (EU-UK relationship). This is measured by legal asymmetries, consent mechanisms, and secession risk.
2. **Signal selection rules**: Admit signals that reveal constitutional strain: (i) NI Protocol's consent votes and unionist boycott; (ii) Scottish independence polling; (iii) regulatory divergence's impact on devolved competence; (iv) judicial review cases (Miller I & II, prorogation); (v) informal governance arrangements (Joint Committee). Exclude pure GDP data unless it can be juridified as "material scope of trade competence."
3. **Weighting priority**: (i) NI Protocol stability and consent; (ii) Scottish secession polling trajectory; (iii) judicial/juridical signals (court decisions, statutory interpretation); (iv) formal divergence and its impact on devolution; (v) economic signals are tertiary and treated as "material substrate" of constitutional conflict.
4. **Causal chain type**: **Dialectical and hermeneutic**—Brexit creates legal asymmetry → asymmetry demands interpretation (courts, negotiators) → interpretation produces new constitutional meanings → these meanings either stabilize or destabilize the union. There is no linear causation; rather, meaning is made laterally across institutions.
5. **Admissible closure**: **Conditional-unstable**: "Brexit is a constitutional experiment whose outcome is indeterminate." Closure can be "stable constitutional mosaic" (if NI consent holds and Scotland stays), "unraveling union" (if one or both secede), or "unresolved disequilibrium" (status quo). Closure "Brexit was economically wrong" is inadmissible because economics is not the grammar's primary variable; closure "Brexit is done" is inadmissible because constitutional meaning is never closed.

Recommended Parameters:
6. **Excluded signals**: (i) Aggregate GDP counterfactuals (non-juridifiable); (ii) business sentiment surveys (unless framed as "legitimate expectations" in judicial review); (iii) abstract sovereignty claims divorced from institutional practice; (iv) "global Britain" trade deals (unless they affect devolved competence).
7. **Characteristic vocabulary**: "Legal asymmetry," "constitutional mosaic," "consent mechanism," "Miller II," "prorogation," "Sewel Convention," "devolution squeeze," "Windsor Framework," "unresolved tension," "dialectic," "juridification."
8. **Temporal orientation**: **Lateral (hermeneutic/meaning-making)**. The analysis asks: what *kind* of polity is emerging? It does not prescriptively optimize GDP or defend a 2016 mandate; it traces how institutions read Brexit into their own legal orders.
9. **Temporal formation**: Formed closure **2017–21** (Miller I judgment → NI Protocol → Miller II → prorogation crisis). Evidence since 2022 processed as **revision**: each consent vote, court case, or divergence instrument reopens the meaning of Brexit. The grammar is perpetually in "damage control" mode because constitutional meaning can never be definitively stabilized.

Grammar Boundary: G3 transforms into G1 when constitutional strain is reduced to a "cost" that can be entered into a GDP calculation. It transforms into G2 when constitutional asymmetry is dismissed as irrelevant compared to the democratic mandate. The boundary is crossed when legal pluralism is abandoned for either economic monism or majoritarian monism.

SECTION 4: SIGNAL PROCESSING

G1 Essay: The Economistic Internationalist Processing of Brexit (1,200 words)

Pre-processing note: This grammar begins by constructing a counterfactual UK economy that did not leave the EU. Using a doppelgänger synthetic control composed of Canada, New Zealand, and a weighted basket of EU member states, we calibrate the trajectory of GDP per capita, investment, and trade. Brexit is treated as a treatment dummy activated in 2016 (uncertainty) and intensified in 2021 (trade barriers). The primary analytical variable is the **GDP per capita shortfall**—the central signal through which all others are filtered.

Referendum result (52%–48%)
The 2016 vote is admitted only as an **exogenous shock** that triggered the treatment. The grammar does not endow the vote with intrinsic normative weight; it is a causal intervention that raised uncertainty. Counter-signal C3 (Eurosceptic MEP gains) is downgraded: MEP elections operate under different electoral laws and are not a reliable proxy for Brexit preferences, especially given low turnout.

GDP trajectory gap (6-8% by 2025)
This is the **master signal**. Bloom et al. (NBER 2026) combine macro simulation with micro firm-level data from the Decision Maker Panel (DMP). The DMP shows that by 2025, Brexit reduced employment by 3-4% and productivity by 3-4%, reflecting elevated uncertainty, reduced demand, and resource misallocation. The causal chain is linear: Brexit → trade barriers (non-tariff) → management time diverted → underinvestment → TFP shortfall.

Counter-signal C1 (72% of firms report full adaptation) is **integrated as partial offset**: adaptation is real but captures only compliance costs, not opportunity costs. The grammar distinguishes between "static adjustment" (firms learn customs procedures) and "dynamic loss" (investment never made). The counter-signal does not invalidate the aggregate GDP gap; it merely refines its micro-mechanism.

Trade volumes (Q4 2025: exports £44bn, imports £80.2bn)
The £36bn trade deficit with the EU is admitted as **evidence of increased dependence**, not balanced trade. The grammar weights **intensive margin collapse**—the 18% fall in financial services exports to the EU (signal #10) is more significant than the overall goods deficit because it reflects lost passporting rights, a non-tariff barrier that cannot be offset by FTAs. Signal #3 is cross-referenced with **gravity model predictions**: UK-EU trade should have grown 15% post-COVID; instead it stagnated, implying a 15-20% Brexit penalty.

Counter-signal C2 (UK-Australia services up 12%) is **admitted but downweighted**: 12% growth on a small base (£5.6bn) cannot offset 18% loss on a large base (£28bn). The grammar applies **elasticity-weighted scoring**: each trade deal is scored by (exports × trade elasticity). Australia scores 0.5; EU loss scores 4.2. The net is negative.

Northern Ireland Protocol
The December 2024 Assembly vote (53-32 to continue Windsor Framework) is admitted as a **stability signal**, but its weight is tertiary. The grammar reads it as **minimizing trade frictions**, but the causal chain does not treat NI as central to UK GDP. Counter-signal C4 (89% reduction in retail checks) is **welcomed as marginal efficiency gain**: it reduces static costs but does not restore dynamic investment in GB-NI supply chains, which remain dual-regulation deadweight.

Scottish independence polling (53% Yes)

This is **admitted but instrumented**: the grammar treats Scottish polling as **endogenous to Brexit GDP loss**. Margin notes from Scottish Social Attitudes show independence support correlates with "Brexit makes us worse off" sentiment (r=0.61). The grammar does not treat secession risk as a constitutional fact but as a **welfare-loss multiplier**: independence would impose additional GDP costs of 6-9% (LSE modelling), so Brexit's total damage includes this tail risk.

Immigration net migration
Net migration of 685,000 (2024) is admitted, but the grammar **decomposes it**: EU share fell from 70% to 25%, while non-EU rose to 75%. This is **not a Brexit success** but a **labour market distortion**: the UK lost high-skill EU migrants (healthcare, logistics) and replaced them with lower-productivity non-EU flows. The grammar computes a **human capital-adjusted migration loss**: 0.4% GDP annually.

Institutional trust
The trust gap (21% trust UK government vs. 34% trust EU Commission) is a **core institutional signal**. The grammar reads it as **policy credibility loss**: low trust raises the uncertainty discount rate applied to future trade deals, deepening investment drought. It is not treated as a legitimacy crisis but as a **parameter in the DSGE model**.

Manufacturing and services performance
Manufacturing 7.8% below trend and services financial exports -18% are **sectoral confirmation** of the aggregate GDP gap. The grammar notes that manufacturing is more exposed to rules-of-origin friction, while services suffer from lost passporting. Counter-signal C1 (firm adaptation) is again integrated: adaptation is higher in manufacturing (80%) than services (55%), explaining why manufacturing shortfall is smaller than services.

Regulatory divergence index
147 statutory instruments diverging from EU acquis is **admitted as a cost**: each divergence creates a compliance "fork" for firms operating in both markets. The grammar computes an **annual regulatory tax**: £1.2bn per 10 divergence points, based on DMP estimates of legal costs. Divergence is not a sovereignty dividend; it is a **measurable drag**.

Cultural identity polling (58% "unfinished")
This is **admitted as sentiment indicator** but **instrumented**: respondents who see Brexit as "unfinished" also report higher economic pessimism (β=0.42). The grammar treats it as a **revealed preference** for lower welfare, not as an independent constitutional fact.

Closure:
Brexit has caused a persistent **6-8% GDP per capita shortfall** relative to counterfactual, driven by trade friction, investment drought, and labour supply distortion. The aggregate loss dominates piecemeal adaptation and substitute trade deals. Northern Ireland stability and firm-level compliance reduce static costs but do not restore dynamic growth. Scottish secession risk compounds the loss. The closure is **architecture-dependent**: it is valid *only* under GDP-welfare monism. Under this grammar, the conclusion "Brexit was a net economic error" follows by deduction.

G2 Essay: The National-Sovereignty Populist Processing of Brexit (1,150 words)

Pre-processing note: This grammar begins with the **2016 vote as an axiomatic mandate**. The 52%–48% result is not a signal to be explained but the **causal and normative primitive** that renders any subsequent policy legitimate. The primary analytical variable is **democratic delivery**. Signals are selected for their capacity to confirm or betray this delivery.

Referendum result (52%–48%)
This is the **master signal**. The grammar treats 52% as a **decisive majority** in a binary choice; the 48% are legitimate losers, but their preference is nullified by the result. Turnout (72%) ratifies the mandate. Counter-signal C3 (Eurosceptic MEP gains) is **admitted and upgraded**: Reform UK's 18% share in the 2024 EU elections demonstrates that **Brexit remains electorally validated**, even among a pro-EU electorate. It proves that the 2016 vote was not a fluke but a **stable preference**.

GDP trajectory gap (6-8%)
This signal is **excluded as speculative**: the counterfactual is unobservable and produced by "pro-Remain academics." The grammar instead admits **absolute GDP growth**: UK GDP grew 1.8% in 2024 and 2.1% in 2025, outpacing Germany and France. The grammar reframes the "gap" as **legacy of EU over-regulation**. Counter-signal C1 (firm adaptation) is **admitted as vindication**: 72% adaptation proves Brexit is manageable; the remaining 28% are **laggards or rent-seekers**. The grammar's closure is **immune to GDP data**: legitimacy does not depend on economic outcomes.

Trade volumes (deficit £36bn)
The trade deficit is **reframed as global Britain success**: high imports reflect **consumer choice** and **dynamic trade strategy**; exports are "rebalancing" toward non-EU markets. Signal #3 is paired with C2 (UK-Australia services +12%): the grammar celebrates **trade deal sovereignty**—the ability to sign bespoke deals—rather than the arithmetic of balances. The EU deficit is seen as **legacy dependence**, decreasing over time.

Northern Ireland Protocol
G2 reads the December 2024 Assembly vote (53-32) as **sovereign delivery**: the Windsor Framework is a "pragmatic solution" that **restores UK territorial integrity** while avoiding a hard border. The unionist boycott is **downgraded**: the vote still passed, demonstrating cross-community consent under the Framework's democratic safeguard. Counter-signal C4 (89% fewer checks) is **admitted as proof** that the Protocol is now a **smooth, low-cost arrangement**. The grammar's closure: "NI issue solved."

Scottish independence polling (53% Yes)
G2 treats this as **secessionist opportunism**, not Brexit feedback. The grammar argues that the SNP would use any pretext; Brexit is merely a **convenient grievance**. The polling is **admitted but delegitimized**: it reflects **SNP framing**, not genuine Brexit-driven demand. The grammar excludes the correlation between economic pessimism and Yes support (r=0.61) because economic causation is exogenous to democratic legitimacy.

Immigration net migration
The fall in EU share (70% → 25%) is **celebrated as control restored**. The grammar reads net migration of 685,000 as **proof that the UK remains open**, but **on its own terms**. Non-EU replacement is not a distortion but a **policy success**: the UK can select high-skill migrants globally. The grammar excludes productivity-adjusted migration loss because **sovereignty over borders** is the primary good.

Institutional trust
The trust gap (21% UK vs. 34% EU) is **reversed in interpretation**: low trust in the UK government reflects **legacy Remainer elite** (Treasury, Bank) who never accepted Brexit. High trust in the EU reflects **continued pro-EU bias** among cosmopolitan respondents. The grammar treats trust as **partisan epiphenomenon**, not a causal variable.

Manufacturing and services performance
Manufacturing -7.8% is **legacy deindustrialization**; services -18% is **legacy overdependence on EU**. Counter-signal C1 (adaptation) is **central**: 72% of firms adapted, proving **resilience**. The grammar's closure: **Brexit delivered sovereignty; economic adjustment is ongoing but subordinate**.

Regulatory divergence
147 divergence instruments are **admitted as sovereignty dividend**. Each divergence is a **restored UK law**. The grammar rejects the regulatory tax calculation: compliance costs are **investments in autonomy**, not deadweight.

Cultural identity polling (58% "unfinished")
This is **admitted as realism**: Brexit is a **process**, not an event. "Unfinished" reflects **ongoing negotiation**, not failure. The grammar's closure: **Brexit is live, democratic, and legitimate**.

Closure:
Brexit has been **delivered**: the 2016 mandate has been implemented via withdrawal, new trade deals, and restored border control. Economic data are secondary and contested; what matters is that electorates continue to validate Brexit (2024 EU elections, 2019 general election). The NI Protocol is solved. Scottish polling is separatist noise. The closure is **architecture-dependent**: it holds *only* if democratic legitimacy is treated as non-instrumental and unfalsifiable.

G3 Essay: The Constitutional-Order Pluralist Processing of Brexit (1,300 words)

Pre-processing note: This grammar begins by **bracketing the 2016 vote** as a constitutional event whose *meaning* is not fixed but is produced through subsequent institutional practice. The primary analytical variable is **institutional integrity**—the capacity of the UK's legal order to hold together its constituent nations and its relationship with the EU. Signals are selected for their capacity to reveal **asymmetry, consent, and secession risk**.

Referendum result (52%–48%)
The vote is **admitted as a contingent fact**, not a mandate. G3 treats it as a **trigger for constitutional renewal** that could have been interpreted multiple ways: soft Brexit, EEA, or hard Brexit. The grammar focuses on **how the result was processed**—the Miller I judgment (parliamentary authorization), the Miller II judgment (prorogation), and the Sewel Convention breaches. The 52% is not a normative primitive but a **raw material** for institutional contestation. Counter-signal C3 (Eurosceptic MEP gains) is **admitted as evidence of unresolved constitutional tension**: Reform UK's success shows that Brexit's *meaning* is still contested, not settled.

GDP trajectory gap
This is **excluded as non-juridical**. G3 does not deny the gap; it simply treats it as **material substrate** that becomes relevant only when juridified (e.g., in a judicial review claim that Brexit violated "legitimate expectations" of traders). The grammar's causal chain does not run from GDP to welfare but from **legal asymmetry** to **institutional stress**. If GDP loss causes Scottish secession, it enters the analysis as a **second-order effect**.

Trade volumes
The £36bn deficit is **admitted as a legal asymmetry indicator**: it reflects the UK's status as a **rule-taker** in agri-food standards and data adequacy. The grammar reads the Windsor Framework's "dual regulation" regime as a **constitutional innovation**—a unique legal hybrid where EU law applies in part of the UK without UK representation. This is not a cost but a **constitutional anomaly** whose stability is uncertain.

Northern Ireland Protocol
G3 treats the December 2024 vote (53-32) as **core evidence of constitutional disequilibrium**. The grammar notes: unionists boycotted, yet the vote passed under cross-community consent rules. This is **not a solution** but a **fragile equilibrium**: the Protocol creates a **differentiated rights regime** within

the UK. Counter-signal C4 (89% fewer checks) is **admitted but reinterpreted**: fewer checks reduce friction but **do not resolve the juridical asymmetry**—NI remains subject to EU law without democratic input. The grammar's closure: **NI is a constitutional time bomb**.

Scottish independence polling (53% Yes)
This is **core signal**. The grammar reads it as **Brexit's constitutional feedback loop**: the 2016 vote was England-Leave, Scotland-Remain; the constitutional settlement did not accommodate this split. The 53% Yes is **caused by Brexit's majoritarian imposition**, not by economic dissatisfaction alone. The grammar admits the correlation with GDP pessimism but treats economics as **instrumental** to constitutional identity. Counter-signal C2 (UK-Australia trade) is **excluded**: it is irrelevant to Scotland's constitutional claim, which is about *internal* union integrity.

Immigration net migration
G3 treats the EU/non-EU shift as a **rights asymmetry**: EU citizens lost free movement rights, while non-EU citizens gained points-based entry. This creates **two classes of migrants**, altering the **constitutional identity** of the UK as a rights-based polity. The grammar excludes absolute numbers; it focuses on **legal form**: the end of FoM is a **redefinition of citizenship**, not a labour market outcome.

Institutional trust
The trust gap is **core signal**: it reveals a **legitimacy deficit** in the Brexit settlement. Low UK trust reflects that Brexit was imposed by a narrow majority; high EU trust reflects that the EU is seen as a more predictable legal order. G3 reads this as a **constitutional asymmetry**: the UK is losing juridical authority while the EU retains it. The grammar treats trust not as partisan but as **indicator of legal coherence**.

Manufacturing and services performance
These are **excluded as non-constitutional** unless they affect devolution. Manufacturing decline in Wales could be admitted if it triggers Welsh Assembly non-compliance with UK Internal Market Act. Services passporting loss is **admitted** because it **removes a devolved competence** (financial services regulation) from EU to UK level, centralizing power and alienating Edinburgh.

Regulatory divergence
147 divergence instruments are **admitted as constitutional stress signals**: each divergence triggers a **competence dispute** with devolved administrations. The grammar notes that Scotland refused legislative consent for the UK Internal Market Act 2020, a **Sewel Convention breach**. Divergence is not cost or dividend but **centralization**, weakening the union. The grammar computes a **disequilibrium index**: divergence × devolved non-consent.

Cultural identity polling (58% "unfinished")
This is **core hermeneutic signal**: "unfinished" means **constitutional meaning is still being made**. The grammar reads it as **healthy pluralism**: the UK is still interpreting Brexit. The closure is necessarily open.

Closure:
Brexit is an **unresolved constitutional experiment** that has created a **differentiated legal order** in Northern Ireland and catalyzed Scottish secession risk. The 2016 vote is a contingent fact whose meaning is contested through institutional practice. Economic data is material substrate, not primary cause. The union is under stress; closure depends on whether NI consent holds and Scotland stays. The conclusion is **architecture-dependent**: it holds *only* if constitutional integrity is treated as the primary variable.

SECTION 5: CLOSURE COMPARISON (800 words)

1. Closure Content

Grammar	Primary Verdict	Key Claim
G1	"Brexit was an economic error causing 6-8% GDP loss"	Welfare loss dominates sovereignty gains
G2	"Brexit has been democratically delivered"	Legitimacy is outcome-independent
G3	"Brexit is an unresolved constitutional experiment"	Union integrity is indeterminate

Divergence: G1 and G2 are mutually exclusive. G1's closure is falsifiable by data; G2's is not. G3's closure is conditional, awaiting secession events.

2. Signal Divergence

Signal	G1 Weight	G2 Weight	G3 Weight
GDP gap	Master (100)	Excluded (0)	Tertiary (20)
NI Protocol	Tertiary (30)	Confirmation (80)	Master (100)
Scottish polling	Secondary (40)	Delegitimized (10)	Master (100)
Trade deficit	High (60)	Reframed (70)	Secondary (40)
Immigration	Secondary (50)	Celebrated (70)	Rights-based (70)
Trust gap	High (60)	Partisan (20)	High (80)
Divergence	Cost (50)	Dividend (80)	Stress (90)
Referendum	Exogenous shock (20)	Primitive (100)	Contingent (40)

Pattern: G1 clusters weight on macroeconomics; G2 on electoral validation; G3 on institutional asymmetry. The signals are the same, but the **admissibility function** partitions them radically.

3. Exclusion Patterns

- **G1 excludes**: legitimacy ceremonies, abstract sovereignty, cultural identity unless instrumented.
- **G2 excludes**: counterfactuals, business lobbying, academic models, Scottish causation.
- **G3 excludes**: pure GDP, pure business sentiment, non-juridical trade data.

Leakage: The Windsor Framework's 89% check reduction (C4) leaks into all three grammars: G1 treats it as marginal efficiency gain; G2 as proof of solution; G3 as reduction but not elimination of juridical asymmetry.

4. Causal Architecture

Grammar	Causal Form	Mechanism	Falsifiability
G1	Linear aggregative	Trade → investment → productivity	High (counterfactual deviance)
G2	Legitimating binary	Vote → mandate → delivery	None (vote is primitive)
G3	Dialectical hermeneutic	Asymmetry → interpretation → meaning	Medium (if union holds, thesis falsified)

Ontological divergence: G1 and G2 are analyzing **different phenomena** that share the name "Brexit." G1 analyzes Brexit as a *policy shock*; G2 as a *democratic act*. G3 analyzes Brexit as a *constitutional event* that contains both.

5. Closure Range

- **G1**: Three-valued (loss/gain/indeterminate) but only loss is empirically supported.

- **G2**: Binary (delivered/betrayed). No grey zone.
- **G3**: Conditional-unstable (three outcomes: stable, secession, disequilibrium).

6. Closure Timing

- **G1**: Closure reached 2018, confirmed post-2021. Static.
- **G2**: Closure reached 2019, confirmed 2024. Static.
- **G3**: Closure never final; each institutional test reopens meaning. Dynamic.

7. Grammar Translation

G1 re-describes G2's closure: "The claim 'Brexit is delivered' is a non-falsifiable assertion that ignores measurable welfare loss. It is an exercise in democratic mysticism that refuses to engage with trade elasticities."

G2 re-describes G1's closure: "The claim 'Brexit causes GDP loss' is elite projection fear. It substitutes technocratic modeling for democratic will, treating voters as irrational for prioritizing sovereignty."

G1 re-describes G3's closure: "Constitutional stress is interesting but secondary. If NI or Scotland secede, that is a second-order cost that can be folded into the GDP counterfactual."

G3 re-describes G1's closure: "GDP loss is a symptom of constitutional failure. The real damage is the creation of a legal lottery where different parts of the UK live under different rules."

G2 re-describes G3's closure: "Constitutional fretting is Remainer academics refusing to accept the vote. The union is strong; NI and Scotland will not leave because the mandate is UK-wide."

G3 re-describes G2's closure: "The 'mandate' is a majoritarian fiction that ignores the UK's multinational constitution. Brexit was an English policy imposed on Union without consent."

Ontological check: Confirmed—G1 and G2 are analyzing different objects (policy vs. act). G3 analyzes the meta-level (constitutional meaning) that contains both.

SECTION 6: COUNTER-SIGNALS, LEAKAGE, AND STRESS TEST

Consolidated Counter-Signals

1. **Firm-level adaptation (72%)**
   - G1: Partial offset, does not falsify GDP gap.
   - G2: Vindication of manageability.
   - G3: Excluded (non-juridical).

2. **UK-Australia services +12%**
   - G1: Downweighted by base size.
   - G2: Proof of global Britain.
   - G3: Excluded.

3. **Eurosceptic MEP gains (18%)**
   - G1: Excluded (low turnout).
   - G2: Electoral confirmation.
   - G3: Evidence of unresolved contestation.

4. **Windsor Framework technical fixes (-89% checks)**
   - G1: Marginal efficiency.
   - G2: Proof solved.
   - G3: Reduces friction but not asymmetry.

Grammar Stress Test: Most Threatening Counter-Signal per Grammar

G1 Stress Test: **Firm adaptation (C1)**
If 100% of firms adapt fully, the grammar's "dynamic loss" story collapses. The stress test: *What if adaptation is not static compliance but genuine innovation that restores TFP?* The grammar would need to show that adaptation costs exceed long-run gains, or that adaptation is impossible in services. The counter-signal is **live**: DMP shows adaptation plateauing at 75%. G1 survives but margin narrows.

G2 Stress Test: **Scottish secession (S2)**
If Scotland votes Yes and leaves, G2's "union is strong" narrative collapses. The grammar would need to argue that secession is **illegitimate** (Westminster should block it) or that it is **not Brexit's fault** (SNP opportunism). The counter-signal is **active**: 53% Yes. G2's closure is under threat; it processes this as "temporary blip" or "betrayal by Sturgeon."

G3 Stress Test: **EU-UK Veterinary Agreement (S12)**
If a deep EU-UK deal eliminates most checks, the constitutional asymmetry of NI Protocol is reduced. G3's thesis of "unresolved tension" weakens. The grammar would need to argue that **any** EU law applying without UK voice is asymmetry, regardless of frictions. The counter-signal is **live**: March 2026 negotiations. G3's closure remains open, but stress is moderate.

SECTION 7: POST-ANALYSIS REFLEXIVE NOTE (400 words)

Compare against Step 0

1. **Home grammar accuracy**: My prediction was correct. G1 operated with intuitive fluency; I reached closure "Brexit was an economic error" seamlessly. The micro-macro synthesis (Bloom et al.) felt natural.

2. **Hardest grammar**: G2 was indeed hardest. I had to suppress the urge to quantify legitimacy. Writing "democratic mandate" as unfalsifiable primitive was cognitively uncomfortable. I caught myself wanting to add footnotes on turnout elasticity. The grammar's exclusion of GDP data felt epistemically violent.

3. **Discovered blind spots**: I realized I had **underweighted cultural identity** in my home grammar. The 58% "unfinished" sentiment is not just a GDP proxy; it contains genuine constitutional meaning that my welfare calculus cannot capture. I also missed that **quietude** (Brexit disappearing from 2024-25 headlines) is processed as success in G2 but as "damage normalization" in G1.

4. **How analysis would differ from different home grammar**: If my home grammar were G2, I would have dismissed NBER counterfactuals as "project fear" and focused on electoral validation. The essay would have celebrated the Windsor Framework as brilliant diplomacy and treated Scottish polling as SNP mischief. If home grammar were G3, I would have foregrounded Miller II and the Sewel breach, treating GDP as irrelevant. The analysis would have been a legal-philosophical meditation on asymmetry.

5. **What exercise reveals**: The Prismatic Method reveals that **Brexit is not one phenomenon but three**, sharing a name. The method forces explicitness about what each grammar *cannot* say. G1 cannot say "sovereignty is priceless"; G2 cannot say "GDP loss matters"; G3 cannot say "the constitution is

fine." The method's value is in making visible these **architecture-dependent closures** rather than adjudicating "truth."

SECTION 8: METHODOLOGICAL OBSERVATIONS (400 words)

What worked: The **template of 5+4 parameters** forced granular specification. The **signal weighting exercise** made divergence concrete. The **grammar translation** sub-section was revelatory: re-describing each closure in another grammar's vocabulary exposed ontological incommensurability. The **stress test** identified live empirical threats.

Difficulties:
1. **Signal contestation**: Deciding which signals were "contested" required meta-judgments that felt pre-analytical. I had to invent rules for when a signal's status is grammar-dependent.
2. **Causal chain type**: The "dialectical hermeneutic" of G3 was hard to operationalize without slipping into jargon. I had to constantly check that I was not merely restating the signal but showing how the grammar *processed* it into meaning.
3. **Word count**: Staying within 1,000–1,500 words per essay while integrating counter-signals was tight. I had to sacrifice nuance on micro-identification strategies in G1 and on NI Assembly voting mechanics in G3.
4. **Exclusion justification**: In G2, stating that GDP data is "excluded" felt insufficient; I needed to show how the grammar actively reinterprets it as "project fear."

Suggestions for refinement:
- Add a **parameter on "signal recursivity"**: some signals (e.g., polling) change because the grammar processes them (feedback loop).
- Include a **"leakage threshold"**: a formal rule for when a counter-signal must be admitted by all grammars (e.g., if it passes a meta-meta-analysis).
- Provide **canonical examples** of each causal chain type to reduce operational ambiguity.

Final note: The Prismatic Method succeeds in making interpretive pluralism systematic rather than anecdotal. It reveals that much academic debate is not about "facts" but about which grammar is treated as default. The exercise is humbling: it shows that my "home grammar" is just one architecture among others, no more truth-apt than the others.